

# Kansas Driver's Test - Study Guide

A complete, plain-English summary of the entire Kansas Driving Handbook (AAMVA / Feb 2022), condensed for studying. Practice tests and the answer key are separate files.

**The knowledge test:** 25 multiple-choice questions on traffic laws, signs, and pavement markings. **To pass:** 80% - 20 of 25 correct. Not timed (~15-20 min). Can be taken at a license office or online at [ks.knowtodrive.com](https://ks.knowtodrive.com). **Retakes:** 4 attempts allowed; after the 4th fail you must wait 6 months (\$1.50 re-test fee). **Vision:** Must be at least 20/40 in one eye (glasses/contacts OK).

## THE 1-PAGE CHEAT SHEET (memorize these first)

| Topic                                         | The number / answer                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pass the test                                 | 80% (20 of 25)                                                   |
| Drunk driving (adult)                         | Illegal at <b>.08 BAC</b> or higher                              |
| Under 21 drinking + driving                   | <b>Zero tolerance</b> - any alcohol is illegal (impaired at .02) |
| City / urban speed limit                      | <b>30 mph</b>                                                    |
| State or Federal highway                      | <b>65 mph</b>                                                    |
| County / township road                        | <b>55 mph</b>                                                    |
| Multilane separated highway                   | <b>75 mph</b> (if posted)                                        |
| School zone / business district               | <b>20 mph</b> (when marked/flashing)                             |
| Following distance (normal)                   | <b>2-second rule</b>                                             |
| Following distance (bad weather / motorcycle) | <b>3-4 seconds</b>                                               |
| Signal before a turn (city)                   | <b>100 feet</b> ahead (200 ft above 40 mph)                      |
| No parking near a fire hydrant                | within <b>15 feet</b>                                            |
| Stay back from emergency vehicle              | <b>500 feet</b>                                                  |
| Vision requirement                            | <b>20/40</b>                                                     |
| License expires                               | <b>On your birthday</b>                                          |
| Yield to pedestrians                          | <b>Always</b> - even jaywalkers                                  |
| 4-way stop tie                                | Car <b>on the right</b> goes                                     |

## 1. LICENSE, PERMITS & THE LAW

- A Kansas license is required to drive on public roads; you must get one **within 90 days** of moving to Kansas.

- **Driving is a privilege, not a right** - it can be suspended or revoked.
- **Class C license** = passenger vehicles **under 26,001 lbs.**

#### Graduated Driver's Licensing (GDL) - teen stages:

- **Instruction Permit (14+):** Drive **only** with a licensed adult **21+** (with 1+ years' experience) in the **front seat**. No wireless device use. No other person but the adult in the front seat.
- **Restricted License (15):** Held learner's permit 1 year; limited driving (to/from school, work, religious activities); no non-sibling minor passengers; supervised by a licensed adult.
- **Less-restricted (16):** May drive 5 a.m.-9 p.m. and to school/work/religious activities; only **one** non-sibling minor passenger.
- **Unrestricted (17):** All age-related restrictions removed (after holding restricted license 6 months past age 16).

#### Losing your license:

- **3 moving violations within 12 months** -> suspension.
- Refusing a chemical (BAC) test -> **1-year** suspension (1st refusal; longer for repeats).
- DUI, no insurance, failure to appear, leaving an accident -> suspension/revocation.

**Documents to bring (general):** proof of identity/lawful presence (List A/B), Social Security proof, and **two** proofs of Kansas residency. **Real ID** (for flights/federal buildings after May 3, 2023) requires originals (not laminated/photocopied).

**Organ donor:** Anyone **18+** can register as a donor on their license (first-person consent - legally binding). Under 18 needs a parent's signature.

## 2. SIGNS - Know the SHAPE and COLOR

The test shows signs by shape, color, or symbol - sometimes with no words. Color and shape alone tell you the type.

### Shapes

| Shape                                       | Always means                                             |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Octagon</b> (8 sides)                    | <b>STOP</b> - only sign with 8 sides                     |
| <b>Triangle</b> (point down)                | <b>YIELD</b> - only sign this shape                      |
| <b>Pennant</b> (sideways triangle, on left) | <b>NO PASSING ZONE</b> - only pennant sign               |
| <b>Diamond</b>                              | <b>Warning</b> - hazard ahead                            |
| <b>Pentagon</b> (5 sides, point up)         | <b>School zone / school crossing</b>                     |
| <b>Round</b>                                | <b>Railroad crossing ahead</b> (yellow circle, "RR" + X) |
| <b>Crossbuck</b> (white X)                  | Railroad crossing - <b>at the tracks</b>                 |
| <b>Rectangle / square</b>                   | Regulatory rule, guide, or service info                  |

### Colors

| Color                    | Means                                                      |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Red                      | Stop or prohibition (Stop, Yield, Wrong Way, Do Not Enter) |
| Yellow                   | General <b>warning</b> (curve, hill, intersection ahead)   |
| Orange                   | <b>Work zone / construction</b>                            |
| Fluorescent yellow-green | School, pedestrian, bicycle crossing                       |
| Fluorescent pink         | <b>Incident</b> (crash, hazmat, emergency detour)          |
| White (black text)       | <b>Regulatory</b> - a law you must obey (Speed Limit)      |
| Green                    | <b>Guide</b> - directions, distances, exits                |
| Blue                     | <b>Services</b> - gas, food, lodging, hospital, phone      |
| Brown                    | Recreation - parks, historical sites                       |

**Red circle with a slash** = that action is **prohibited** (No Left Turn, No U-Turn).

### Specific signs worth memorizing

- **No Turn on Red** -> may NOT turn on red; wait for green.
- **Stop Here on Red** -> stop at this line on red (right turn still allowed after stopping).
- **Do Not Enter** (white bar in red circle) -> wrong way / don't enter.
- **Wrong Way** -> you're going the wrong direction; turn around.
- **Keep Right / Slower Traffic Keep Right** -> stay right unless passing.
- **Shared Center Lane (Left Turn Only)** -> middle lane for left turns from both directions only - never through traffic or passing.
- **Slow-Moving Vehicle** (orange/red triangle) -> vehicle going **under 25 mph** (farm equipment, buggies).
- **Route markers**: shield shape/color shows interstate, U.S., or state route.
- **Exit signs**: "Exit" on the **left** of the sign = exit is on the left; on the **right** = exit on the right.

## 3. TRAFFIC SIGNALS (lights)

| Light                  | What to do                                                                                     |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Steady GREEN</b>    | Go if clear. Yield to pedestrians & oncoming traffic when turning left.                        |
| <b>GREEN ARROW</b>     | Protected turn - oncoming traffic is stopped.                                                  |
| <b>Steady YELLOW</b>   | Light is about to turn red. <b>Stop if you safely can.</b>                                     |
| <b>Flashing YELLOW</b> | Slow down, proceed with <b>caution</b> .                                                       |
| <b>Steady RED</b>      | <b>Stop</b> behind the line. Right turn on red OK after a full stop (unless "No Turn on Red"). |
| <b>Flashing RED</b>    | Treat exactly like a <b>stop sign</b> - full stop, then go when clear.                         |
| <b>RED ARROW</b>       | Stop. No turn in that direction until it changes.                                              |

## 4. PAVEMENT MARKINGS

Easy rule: **YELLOW** separates opposite directions. **WHITE** separates same direction.

| Line                                          | Meaning                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Dashed yellow                                 | Passing allowed if safe                               |
| Solid yellow on YOUR side                     | <b>No passing</b>                                     |
| Double solid yellow                           | No passing either direction (may cross only to turn)  |
| Dashed white                                  | Changing lanes is OK                                  |
| Solid white                                   | Stay in your lane                                     |
| Center lane, solid + dashed yellow both sides | Shared center <b>left-turn</b> lane (both directions) |

- **Reversible lanes:** green arrow = lane open; red **X** = closed; flashing yellow X = move out of it.
- **Reserved lanes:** white diamond = HOV/bus/bike. "HOV 3" = 3+ people required.

## 5. RIGHT-OF-WAY (who goes first)

Key idea: the law only says who must **YIELD**. It never gives you the right-of-way - you must make sure it's safe.

- **Pedestrians always win** - yield even if they jaywalk.
- **Blind pedestrian** (white cane or guide dog) -> **always stop**. Don't honk (it scares them).
- **Turning left** -> yield to oncoming traffic going straight or turning right.
- **Uncontrolled intersection** (no signs) -> yield to the car **on your right**.
- **4-way stop** -> first to arrive goes. **Tie? The car on the right goes.**
- **Entering from a driveway/alley/private road** -> yield to traffic already on the road.
- **Roundabout/traffic circle** -> yield to traffic **already in the circle** ; go **counterclockwise** ; slow to **15-20 mph** ; don't change lanes or pass; signal right before your exit.
- **Emergency vehicle** (lights/siren) -> pull to the **right and stop** ; stay **500 ft** back.
- **Never enter an intersection** (even on green) unless you can get all the way through.

## 6. STOPPING & SCHOOL BUSES

Come to a **FULL STOP** for:

- A stop sign, a red light, or a **flashing red** light
- A **school crossing guard** holding a flag
- A flag person at a railroad crossing or construction site
- An emergency vehicle approaching with lights/siren
- Pulling out of an alley/driveway in a business or residential area

**School buses:**

- **Stop** when a school/church/daycare bus has **red lights flashing** or its **stop arm out** - whether it's on

your side OR the oncoming side of an undivided road (two yellow lines between).

- **Exception:** On a **divided highway**, traffic going the **opposite** direction does **not** stop.
  - Stay stopped until the red lights stop flashing and the stop arm folds in.
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## 7. SPEED, STOPPING & FOLLOWING DISTANCE

- **Basic Speed Law:** Never drive faster than is reasonable and prudent for conditions - even below the posted limit (rain, fog, traffic). 55 mph in a snowstorm is **not** legal just because it's posted.
- **2-second rule** (good conditions); **add a second** for rain, night, gravel, heavy loads, tailgaters, or following motorcycles/large trucks.
- It's illegal to drive **so slowly** you block traffic; driving **15+ mph slower** than traffic flow is as dangerous as speeding.

**Stopping distance (a frequent test topic):**

- Total stopping distance = **perception + reaction + braking** distance.
- **Perception time** for an alert driver **3/4 to 1 second**.
- Doubling speed (20->40 mph) makes braking distance **4 longer**; tripling (20->60) makes it **9**; 80 mph **16** the impact of 20 mph.
- At 60 mph it takes about **4-5 seconds** / **~360 feet** to perceive and stop.

**Merging / changing lanes:** Look for a **4-6 second gap**. Check mirrors **and** your blind spot (over your shoulder) before moving. Use the acceleration lane to match traffic speed; don't stop at its end. Don't cross a solid white line.

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## 8. PASSING

- Pass on the **left**. Signal, make sure it's clear, don't exceed the speed limit.
  - Return only when you see the passed car in your rearview mirror - and **before** you're within **200 feet** of any oncoming car.
  - **Do NOT pass when:**
    - Within **100 feet** of a bridge, tunnel, intersection, or railroad crossing
    - On a hill or curve, or any marked no-passing zone (you can't see **1/3 mile** / **~20-25 sec** ahead)
    - There's a **solid yellow line on your side**
    - Within **100 feet** of a stopped emergency vehicle (lights on)
  - **Passing on the right** is allowed only on one-way streets or multilane roads going the same direction. **Never pass on the shoulder.**
  - If you're **being passed:** keep right, hold a steady speed, don't speed up.
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## 9. ALCOHOL, DRUGS, DISTRACTION & FITNESS TO DRIVE

- **Illegal at .08 BAC or higher** (adults). **Under 21 = zero tolerance.** Vision is affected at just **.02 BAC**.
- Alcohol/drugs are in about **40% of fatal crashes**.
- **Only time** sobers you up - not coffee, food, or a shower. Body removes **~ one drink per hour**.
- **Implied Consent:** Having a license means you've agreed to a breath/blood/urine test if an officer asks.

**Refusing = lose your license 1 year.**

- **Prescription and over-the-counter drugs** can impair you like alcohol - check labels.
  - **Texting/writing/reading** on a device while driving is **illegal** in Kansas.
  - **Fatigue:** If tired, pull over for a **15-20 minute nap** - don't "push through."
  - **Cell phone:** best practice is to **stop in a safe spot** to call/text.
  - **Emotions:** Angry or upset? Cool off before driving. **Aggressive driver?** Get out of their way, don't make eye contact, don't challenge them.
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## 10. SEAT BELTS, AIR BAGS & CHILD SAFETY

- **Seat belts required for ALL occupants** - a **primary violation** (police can stop you just for that).
  - Wear belts **even with air bags** - air bags don't protect in side impacts or rollovers and won't keep you behind the wheel.
  - Shoulder belt across the shoulder/chest (never under the arm or behind the back); lap belt low and snug across the hips.
  - **Under 4** -> child safety seat. **4-8** -> safety/booster seat unless taller than **4'9"** OR over **80 lbs** -> then a seat belt. **8+** -> seat belt.
  - **Children 12 and under** should ride in the **back seat**.
  - **Never** put a **rear-facing infant seat in front of an active airbag**. Keep ~ **10 inches** between your chest and the steering wheel.
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## 11. PARKING

### No parking:

- Within an intersection or crosswalk
- Within **15 feet** of a fire hydrant
- More than **12 inches** from the curb
- In front of a driveway, on a sidewalk, on a bridge, or in a tunnel
- Within **30 feet** of a stop sign, signal, or flashing beacon
- Within **50 feet** of a railroad crossing
- Within **20 feet** of a fire-station driveway (75 ft on the opposite side)
- In a handicapped space without a permit

### Parking on a hill (test favorite):

- **Downhill** -> turn wheels **toward** the curb.
- **Uphill WITH a curb** -> turn wheels **away** from the curb.
- **No curb (either way)** -> turn wheels **toward** the shoulder/edge.

(Logic: if your brakes fail, the curb or roadside stops the car instead of rolling into traffic.)

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## 12. SHARING THE ROAD

- **Bicyclists** have the same rights/rules as cars; they ride on the right and use hand signals. Give them

room when passing; don't honk close to them. Watch for **"Dead Red Law"** (a cyclist may cross on a light that won't detect them).

- **Motorcycles/mopeds** get a **full lane**. They're hard to see - check blind spots. Follow at **3-4 seconds**. Don't assume they're turning just because a signal is on (signals may not self-cancel). A **moped** has 3.5 hp and tops out at ~30 mph.
  - **Emergency vehicles** (siren/lights): pull to the **right and stop**. Stay **500 feet** back.
  - **Move-Over Law**: Approaching a stopped emergency/tow vehicle with flashing lights -> move over a lane if you can, or slow down.
  - **Large trucks/buses** have huge blind spots ("**No-Zones**") - front, rear, and both sides. If you can't see the driver's mirror, they can't see you. They swing **wide** for turns - never squeeze between a turning truck and the curb. A loaded truck at 55 mph needs **11/2** a car's stopping distance.
  - **Transit bus**: You do **not** have to stop for a transit bus (unlike a school bus) - but watch for pedestrians around it.
  - **Slow-moving vehicles** (farm equipment, animal-drawn): orange/red triangle = under 25 mph. Pass with caution; they may swing left before a right turn.
  - **Trains**: Never shift gears on the tracks. If you stall on the tracks, get out and **run toward the direction the train is coming from** (debris flies away from you). A 100-car train at 55 mph needs over **a mile** to stop. Always expect a train.
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## 13. BEFORE YOU DRIVE & BASIC CONTROL

- **Adjust seat and mirrors before driving**. Top of the steering wheel no higher than your shoulders; ~ **10 inches** from your chest to the wheel.
  - **Head restraint** should contact the back of your head (not below your ears) to prevent whiplash.
  - **Steering - preferred method is hand-to-hand (push/pull)**, hands at **9 and 3** (or 8 and 4). The old **10-and-2** is not recommended because of airbags. Use **one hand only** when backing or operating controls.
  - **Backing**: Check behind the vehicle first, go slow, turn and look over your shoulder through the rear window (mirrors don't show directly behind you). It's illegal to back in a travel lane except to parallel park.
  - **Before starting**: make sure the **parking brake is set**, then start. **Before stopping**: check mirrors for traffic.
  - **Traction technology**: **ABS** lets you brake and steer at the same time without skidding - press **firmly and hold** (don't pump). Remember **Search, Stomp, Steer**. **ESP** (stability control) helps prevent skids.
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## 14. VISUAL SEARCH & COMMUNICATING

- **Scan well ahead** - look **12-15 seconds** down the road (city: ~2 blocks; highway: ~1/4 mile). Keep your eyes moving; check mirrors every few seconds and before any lane change, slow-down, or hill.
- **Headlights**: Turn them on when it gets dark, in rain/snow/fog, and **whenever your wipers are on** (required in Kansas). High beams see twice as far - but **dim** them within ~one block (500 ft) of an oncoming car or when following someone.
- **Horn**: A light tap to warn someone who may not see you. A **sharp blast** only in real danger. Don't use it to greet people, hurry others, or near blind pedestrians/horses.
- **Signaling**: Signal **100 ft** before a turn in town ( **200 ft** above 40 mph), or **3-4 seconds** ahead. Cancel it

after the turn.

- **Disabled vehicle:** Get off the road, turn on hazard flashers, raise the hood or tie a white cloth, set flares **200-300 feet** behind.

**Driver hand-and-arm signals** (use these when your signal/brake lights fail - and a common test topic):

| Intention   | Left arm out the window                                |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Left turn   | Arm straight out, horizontal                           |
| Right turn  | Arm bent <b>up</b> at the elbow (hand pointing up)     |
| Slow / stop | Arm bent <b>down</b> at the elbow (hand pointing down) |

You must also obey a **school crossing guard at all times** while they direct traffic.

## 15. NIGHT, WEATHER & EMERGENCIES

**Night:**

- Use **high beams** when no oncoming traffic; **dim** within ~one block. Don't stare into oncoming headlights. **Never wear sunglasses** at night.
- Low beams light ~150-200 ft (safe to ~45 mph); high beams ~350-400 ft (safe to ~65 mph).

**Weather & traction:**

- Roads are **most slippery when rain/snow/sleet FIRST starts** (water mixes with oil and dirt).
- **Reduce speed and increase following distance** on gravel/dirt, wet, or icy roads. **Bridges and overpasses freeze first.**
- **Hydroplaning** starts around **35 mph** on wet roads (worse with worn tires) - slow down in the rain.
- **Adverse weather:** if you can't see more than **100 feet** , don't go faster than **30 mph** ; pull over if it's too bad.
- **Studded snow tires** are legal **Nov 1 - Apr 1** only.

**Skids / losing traction:** Look where you want to go, **ease off the pedals**, and steer toward your intended path - don't slam the brakes or oversteer.

**Emergencies:**

- **Brake failure:** pump the pedal, then use the parking brake gradually, then steer to a safe stop.
- **Tire blowout:** grip the wheel, **don't brake hard**, ease off the gas, let it slow, pull off.
- **Stuck accelerator / power loss:** shift to **neutral** , steer to the side, brake gently.
- **Avoiding a crash:** you can usually **steer** away faster than you can stop. With ABS, brake hard **and** steer.
- **Rollovers:** mostly single-vehicle; caused by speed and oversteering. SUVs/vans/pickups are more prone. **Seat belts** are the best protection.
- **Flooded road: turn around. 6 inches** of water can move a car; **2 feet** can sweep it away.
- **Animals: don't swerve** - brake and stay in your lane. Deer are most active at **dawn/dusk** and **Oct-Dec**.

**Seasonal (optional section):**

- **Winter:** carry a survival kit; if stranded, **stay with the vehicle** , run the engine ~10 min/hour, keep the



exhaust pipe clear, crack a window.

- **Hot weather:** watch tire pressure, coolant, and "bleeding tar" (slippery).
  - **Tornado:** leave the vehicle for sturdy shelter; **don't hide under an overpass.**
  - **Lightning:** stay inside a hard-topped vehicle with windows up; don't touch metal.
  - **Trip planning:** limit driving to ~ **6-8 hours/day** (one driver); avoid driving after 11 p.m.
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## Final Tips for Test Day

- Take the knowledge test **online at [ks.knowtodrive.com](https://ks.knowtodrive.com)** or at a license office.
- Read each question fully - wrong answers are often "almost right."
- When unsure, pick the **safest, most cautious** option - it's usually correct.
- Re-read the **1-Page Cheat Sheet** right before you go in.
- Then run the **practice tests** (separate files) until you're scoring **90%+** .

Good luck!

# Road Sign Gallery



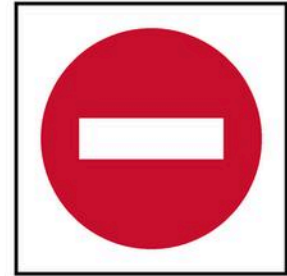
## Stop

Come to a complete stop, then go when clear.



## Yield

Slow down and give the right-of-way before entering.



## Do Not Enter

Do not enter — wrong direction (e.g., an exit ramp).



## Wrong Way

You are going the wrong way; turn around.



## One Way

Traffic flows only in the arrow's direction.



## No Passing Zone

Passing is not allowed (the only pennant-shaped sign).



## Speed Limit

Maximum legal speed in ideal conditions.



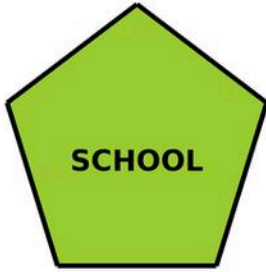
## Railroad Crossing

At the tracks — yield to trains.



## Railroad Ahead

A railroad crossing is ahead; slow, look, and listen.



### **School Zone**

School zone/crossing; watch for children, obey reduced limit.



### **No Left Turn**

Left turns are prohibited here.



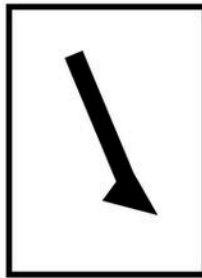
### **No Right Turn**

Right turns are prohibited here.



### **No U-Turn**

U-turns are prohibited here.



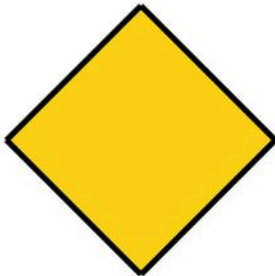
### **Keep Right**

Keep right of a divider, median, or island.



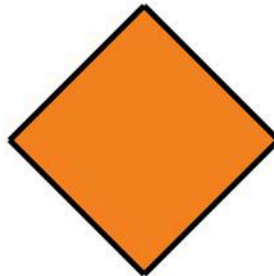
### **Slow-Moving Vehicle**

A vehicle traveling under 25 mph (farm equipment, buggies).



### **Warning**

Yellow diamond = a general warning of a hazard ahead.



### **Work Zone**

Orange diamond = construction or maintenance area ahead.



### **Merge**

Merging traffic ahead; adjust your speed and position.